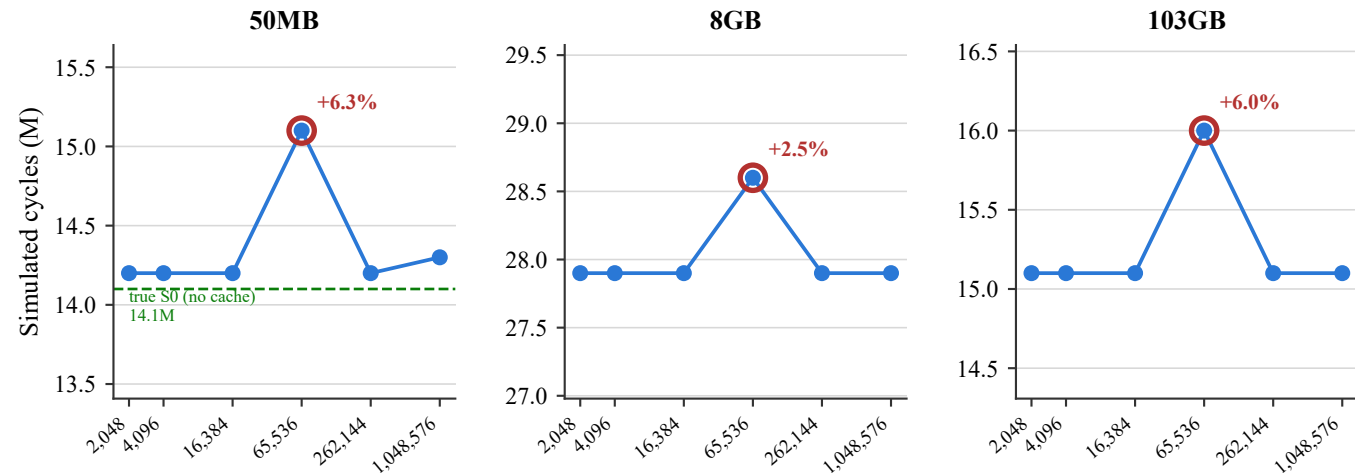


Software cache SIZE sweep: flat baseline, isolated spike at 65,536 sets,
full revert by 262,144 - holds across all three DB sizes



Software S2 cache capacity (entries/sets), FIXED at 4-way associativity - log-x axis

SOFTWARE CACHE CAPACITY (set count), not associativity - fixed at 4-way throughout. This is a different axis from the hardware LLC associativity null result (fig12/fig13) and from the software cache WIDTH sweep (fig1/fig2/fig9-11); do not conflate them. Metric is Sniper cycles_M, never wallclock/elapsed (see command_log.md step 60). Every size except 65,536 sits within ~1% of its own DB's median; 65,536 sets spikes +6.3% (50MB), +2.5% (8GB), +6.0% (103GB), then fully reverts by 262,144 - a fixed absolute set count, not a DB-size-scaled effect. On 50MB, every size tested (including the anomaly) still exceeds true no-cache S0 (14.1M cycles, green dashed line, left panel).